

CANNING TOMATOES AND SALSAS

Adults

Q

Why is it important to add bottled lemon juice or citric acid when canning tomatoes?

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ANSWER

To ensure safe acidity levels preventing botulism

FUN FACT

Tomatoes are borderline acidic and need acid additions to be safely canned.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products

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What is the minimum headspace to leave when filling jars with hot salsa for canning?

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1/2 inch

FUN FACT

Proper headspace prevents jar seal failure during processing.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning

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What is a risk of altering the acid amount in a tested salsa recipe before canning?

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ANSWER

It can make the salsa unsafe and risk botulism

FUN FACT

Maintaining the tested acidity is critical for bacterial safety.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes

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Which type of vinegar is recommended for canning salsas as long as it has the correct acidity?

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White vinegar with 5% acidity

FUN FACT

White vinegar won't discolor your salsa but is acidic enough for safety.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning

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When lemon or lime juice is called for in a salsa recipe, what is NOT a safe substitute?

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Vinegar

FUN FACT

Vinegar is less acidic than lemon or lime juice and can't replace them safely.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning

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What happens if you add extra vegetables or fresh herbs not called for in salsa recipes before canning?

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ANSWER

It may reduce acidity, causing unsafe conditions

FUN FACT

Do not add any extra fresh ingredients that can lower acidity.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes

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Why must you use only tomatoes from healthy, ripe vines for canning salsa?

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Overripe or frost-damaged tomatoes can cause unsafe and poor-quality salsa

FUN FACT

Quality tomatoes ensure safe, tasty canned salsa.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning

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If a salsa recipe is not tested for canning safety, what is the recommended preservation method?

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Freeze or refrigerate instead of canning

FUN FACT

Untested salsas may have unsafe acidity and must be frozen or refrigerated.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes

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For safe canning, how long should you process salsa in a boiling water canner at altitudes of 0-1,000 feet?

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15 minutes

FUN FACT

Processing times increase with elevation to ensure safety.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning

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What type of tomatoes typically yields a thicker salsa when canned?

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Paste tomatoes like Roma

FUN FACT

Paste tomatoes have firmer flesh that makes thicker salsas.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning

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What is a common method to remove tomato skins for salsa canning?

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Dip tomatoes in boiling water for 30-60 seconds to split skins, then cool and peel

FUN FACT

Heating helps loosen tomato skins for easy removal.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning

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Which of the following is a true safety guideline for canning salsas?

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ANSWER

Follow only research-tested recipes with correct acid levels

FUN FACT

Ignoring tested recipes can cause life-threatening foodborne illness.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes

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How should you treat jars and lids before filling them with hot salsa for canning?

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Preheat jars in hot water and follow manufacturers' directions for lids

FUN FACT

Preheating helps prevent jar breakage during canning.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning

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What must you do after filling jars with salsa before processing to ensure safety?

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Remove air bubbles and wipe jar rims clean

FUN FACT

Air bubbles can prevent sealing and lead to spoilage.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning

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Why is it important to use bottled lemon or lime juice instead of fresh for canning salsa?

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ANSWER

Bottled juices have consistent acidity levels needed for safety

FUN FACT

Acidity can vary in fresh juice making it unsafe for canning.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning

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If you live above 6,000 feet altitude, how should you adjust boiling water canning times for salsa?

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Increase processing time (e.g., to 25 minutes)

FUN FACT

Higher altitudes require longer processing for safety.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning

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During salsa preparation for canning, what is the purpose of simmering after boiling?

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ANSWER

To thicken the salsa and develop flavors

FUN FACT

Simmering thickens salsa without overcooking.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning

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What ingredient is essential in salsa recipes to prevent botulism growth during canning?

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Acid like vinegar or bottled lemon/lime juice

FUN FACT

Acid keeps salsa safely acidic to prevent dangerous bacteria.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes

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Can original homemade salsa recipes be safely canned without testing?

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No, untested salsa recipes should be frozen or refrigerated instead

FUN FACT

Only use tested salsa recipes for boiling water canning safety.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes

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What is a safe way to fix a prepared salsa after opening if it tastes too tart?

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Add a small amount of sugar after opening

FUN FACT

Sugar after opening can balance acidity safely without affecting safety.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning